

Austin Todd

Artist Statement and Creative Work Portfolio

I like text on pots, imagery on pots, and the interaction between the two. I pull from all of my interests and thoughts and readings, and I use traditional forms as signifiers which interact, like words, with decorative text and images. I've approached ceramics as a act of collecting, and out of my collections, or my montage of forms, I generate new meaning.



Pandora's Jar, ceramic, stain, glaze. 2024

Included in the 2024 University of Alaska Anchorage Claybody Invitational

Pandora's Jar is a response to the escalating violences, particularly the 2023 genocide in Gaza, of imperialism and capitalism. In conversation with the myth of Pandora, who opened not a box but a jar (the box comes in through a medieval Latin mistranslation), out of which all the evils of the world flew, and inside which only Hope (elpis) remained. The lid of this jar does not open.



Overview images of *Pandora's Jar*



Frog Fermentation Crock, ceramic, glaze, 2024.



Overview image of *Frog Fermentation Crock*



Cow Series, ceramic, glaze with wax resist relief, 2024.

I made the *Cow Series* plates for the UAA bowl drive: make 10 bowls to donate to a local soup kitchen's sale, at which the proceeds go to the kitchen's operations. Pictured are two bowls from the series. The imagery comes from my roots in Arkansas. August 2024, on a hot day, I was driving in Arkansas and saw cows huddling up under trees in the shade. The series is also an experiment with detail, playing with how little figuration is necessary to evoke a scene or image.



How Much Comfort Is The World Worth?, ceramic, stain, 2024.

With this piece I am at my most sculptural. With the form of a shipping container, I interrogate the comforts that come (to the Global North/the West) in such containers. The text poses a challenge which contrasts with the form.



Mug, clay, inlay, slip, glaze, soda fired, 2024.



wearing down,

clay, performance, video, 2022.

Inspired by Paulus Berensohn's book *Finding One's Way with Clay*, this was a performance involving repeatedly pinching a bowl and balling it up. The clay dries out, the bowl cannot hold a form, and at last water replenishes.

https://youtu.be/TlEdaFBPW_k

